History Practice: Unit 1 Historical Skills

6C History 2026-2027 | Quiz on 13 October | Name: _____ Class: _____

1. Which of the following is a PRIMARY source?

(A) A history textbook written last year

(B) A diary written by a soldier during a war

(C) A website article about an old invention

(D) A documentary film made in 2020

2. A photo taken during an event, kept in a museum, is best described as:

(A) a secondary source

(B) a primary source

(C) a timeline

(D) a legend

3. Which of these is a SECONDARY source?

(A) A letter written in 1910

(B) An interview with someone who saw the event

(C) A newspaper editorial written today about a past event

(D) An ancient coin

4. Put these events in chronological order (write 1-4). The Silk Road begins. / Hong Kong is founded as a British colony. / Paper is invented in China. / The printing press is invented in Europe.

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5. How many years are there in a century?

(A) 10

(B) 50

(C) 100

(D) 1000

6. The year 2026 belongs to which century?

(A) the 19th century

(B) the 20th century

(C) the 21st century

(D) the 22nd century

7. BCE stands for:

(A) Before Common Era

(B) Before Central Empire

(C) Between Common Events

(D) Before Century End

8. Which came first: 476 CE or 476 BCE? Explain how you know.

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9. Give ONE example of a CAUSE and its EFFECT in history. (Write: Cause -> Effect)

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10. A historian asks: 'How did people's lives change after the railway was built?' This is a question about:

(A) chronology
(B) change and continuity
(C) cause and effect
(D) using evidence

11. Write down THREE good historical questions you could ask about the unit you studied (start with Who, What, When, Where, Why or How).

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12. Which statement shows CONTINUITY rather than change?

(A) People used candles, then switched to electric lights
(B) Farming villages grew into big cities
(C) Families still celebrate the Mid-Autumn Festival every year
(D) People stopped riding horses and started driving cars

13. A historian finds two old maps of the same place that disagree with each other. What should the historian do? Write TWO sensible steps.

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14. Explain in your own words why historians cannot always trust a single source of evidence.

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Answer Key (for Dad first!)

Q1: B -- a diary written at the time is a primary source (made during the event).

Q2: B -- the photo was made at the time of the event.

Q3: C -- the editorial is written later, interpreting a past event.

Q4: 1: Paper invented in China (~105 CE). 2: Silk Road begins (~130 BCE). 3: Printing press in Europe (~1440 CE). 4: Hong Kong founded (1841 CE). (Order: paper -> Silk Road -> printing press -> HK)

Q5: C -- 100 years.

Q6: C -- the 21st century (2001-2100).

Q7: A -- Before Common Era.

Q8: 476 BCE came first. Time in BCE counts backwards: bigger BCE numbers are older. 476 BCE is before year 1; 476 CE is after year 1.

Q9: Any sensible pair, e.g. Cause: the invention of the printing press -> Effect: books became cheaper and more people could read. (1 mark for a clear cause, 1 for a matching effect)

Q10: B -- change and continuity (how life changed, and what stayed the same).

Q11: Any three questions starting with Who/What/When/Where/Why/How about the unit topic. (1 mark each)

Q12: C -- celebrating the festival every year is something that continues.

Q13: Any two sensible steps, e.g. (1) check which map was made closer to the time / by whom; (2) compare with a third source (diary, book, photo) to see which map matches the other evidence.

Q14: A single source may be biased, mistaken, or only show one point of view. Historians compare several sources to check facts and get a fuller, fairer picture. (2 marks: mention of bias/mistake 1, mention of comparing sources 1)